

HPE Aruba Networking

EdgeConnect Product Lifecycle Policy

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Document revision history

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1.2	2023-09-26				— Applied HPE Aruba Networking EdgeConnect template to entire document — Linked to HPE Networking Support Portal in Software Release Stream Cycle and Definitions section — Updated support for discontinued hardware section and hardware dependencies section
1.3	2023-10-31				Incorporated Hardware End of Life policy
1.4	2024-01-31				Final clarifications & cleanup
1.5	2024-03-19				Final review & approval
2.0	2026-03-09	V. Prabhu	C. McClung	B. Rodio	— Software Release Stream Definitions • FCS is now EA • Releases are designated as either SSR or LSR • SSR are declared EOM when the next release stream is declared GA — End of Support is at least 2 years after End of Maintenance — Defined Last Compatible Software Release — Clarified Hardware Dependencies — Updated Release Stream numbering definitions — Hardware Warranty updated per HPE terms — End of Software Support is 5 years after End of Sale — Rebranded document

Document Overview

The HPE Aruba Networking EdgeConnect product line includes both hardware and software products. This document describes the lifecycle policy for software as well as the End-of-Life policy for hardware.

Software Lifecycle Overview

The HPE Aruba Networking EdgeConnect software lifecycle policy defines the stages of the software lifecycle from initial release to end of support. Our standard support phase begins with the Early Access (EA) date and ends at the End of Support Term (EOST). The intent of this policy allows a rapid introduction of new features and capabilities while aiding customers who seek a more modest upgrade policy with a less aggressive need to introduce new features. Customers are required to have an active software subscription to avail the benefits of software maintenance, software upgrades and 24x7 technical support.

Software Release Stream Cycle and Definitions

The following section outlines and defines the release stream cycle.

- Early Access (EA)
- Generally Available (GA)
- Short Supported Release (SSR)
- Long Supported Release (LSR)
- End of Maintenance (EOM)
- End of Support Term (EOST)

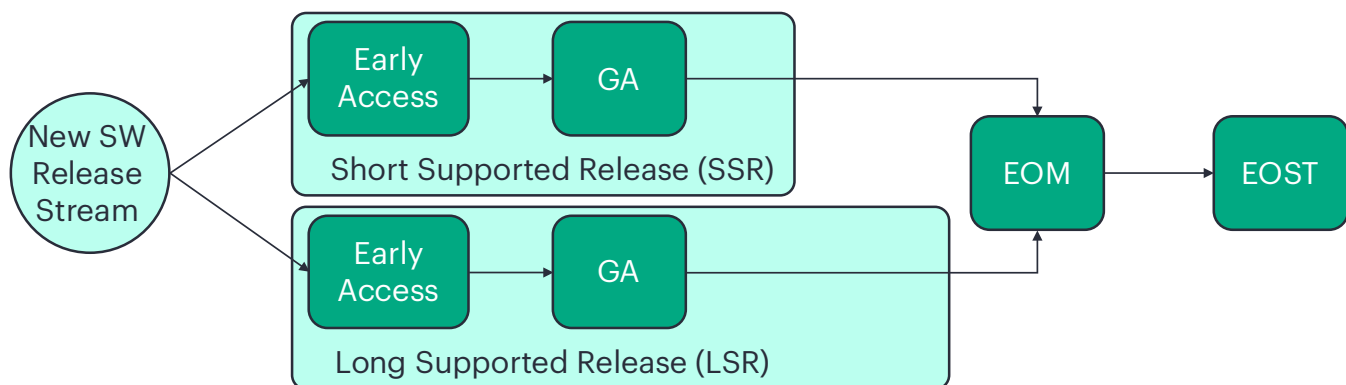


Figure 1: Software Release stream lifecycle

Early Access (EA)

Early Access (EA) is absent of Priority 1 and 2 defects and is accompanied by online documentation, release notes, and generally updated technical document guides.

Generally Available (GA)

For certain EA releases, HPE Aruba Networking may designate the EdgeConnect software release as Generally Available (GA). GA meets the stability, scalability and performance requirements demanded by the market and provides the appropriate set of capabilities that HPE Aruba Networking believes will result in broad customer

adoption. Once a candidate software release is designated as GA, then that specific software release stream is declared GA.

GA releases are accompanied by several ongoing maintenance releases that include incremental fixes encountered by a growing set of customers adopting the GA release.

Maintenance

Starting with GA until EOM, HPE Aruba Networking EdgeConnect software lifecycle policy includes incremental maintenance releases to address certain defects encountered by customers, security patches, and on occasion, incorporate minor feature enhancements, for a release stream.

Support

HPE Aruba Networking provides 24x7 technical support for all GA releases. Access to support is via [HPE Networking Support Portal](#), or for EdgeConnect products, by calling +1 408 935 1850.

More information on support is available here: <https://www.hpe.com/psnow/doc/a0011733enw>.

Long Supported Release (LSR)

For customers seeking to remain on a stable release or prefer to adopt a longer upgrade cycle, HPE Aruba Networking designates certain EdgeConnect release streams as LSR. LSR streams have longer maintenance cycles, and not all release streams become LSR. Once a release stream is designated as LSR, that release stream will be maintained for two (2) years from the day of achieving a GA designation, incorporating ongoing maintenance patches and incremental fixes, but generally no new major features. This approach mitigates risk or unintended side effects associated with new features, while creating a stable release well suited for production environments. Information on the current LSR release streams and the general status of all releases can be found on the HPE Networking Support Portal.

Short Supported Release (SSR)

The release streams that are not designated as LSR will be treated as SSR and will be declared End of Maintenance (EOM) when the next release stream is declared GA as indicated in the diagram below. Only one SSR will be maintained at any given point in time. A new hardware model may be introduced in an SSR which means that this new hardware model may not be backported to an existing LSR.

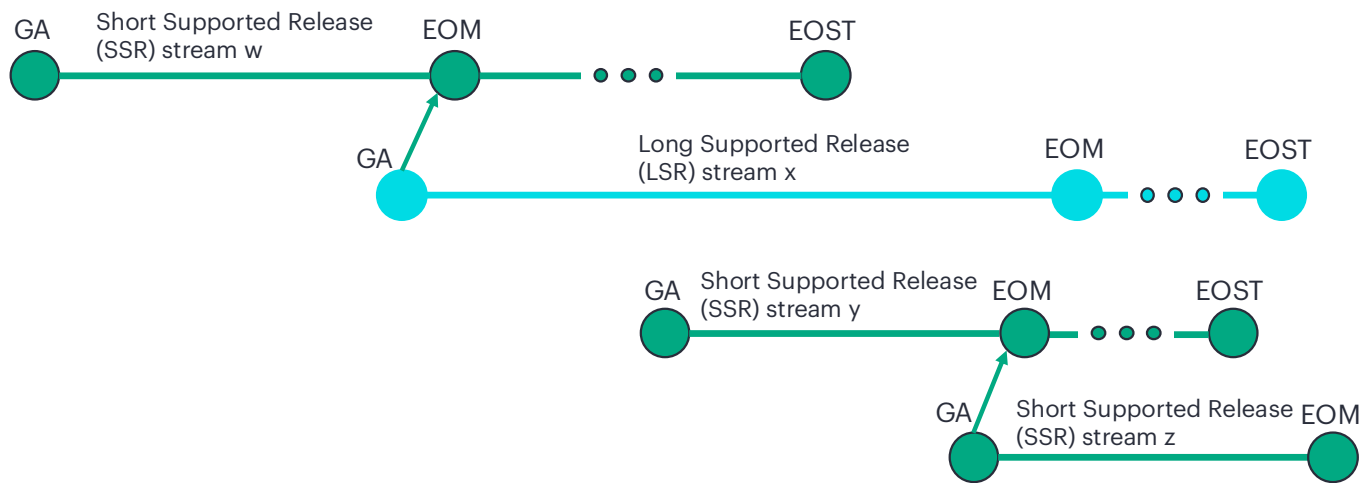


Figure 2: SSR/LSR Release stream relationships

End of Maintenance (EOM)

The EOM announcement indicates the intent to no longer provide maintenance (bug fixes) for the specific software release stream. In the event of a critical or high severity security issue, the vulnerability may be patched even though the release is EOM. If a customer has a valid software license deployed on the appliance (hardware or virtual), or is under a valid Hardware maintenance contract, HPE Aruba Networking will continue to provide 24x7 technical support for the release until the software is EOST. A list of current EOM releases is available on the [HPE Networking Support Portal](#).

End of Support (EOST)

As releases age and newer releases are introduced into the market, HPE Aruba Networking may declare EOST for a software release. These are releases that will be no longer supported by 24x7 technical support. An EOST announcement is generally made at least 12 months prior to the intended EOST date. A release will be declared as EOST after being in an EOM state for at least 2 years.

Last Compatible Software Release and Support for Discontinued Hardware

From time-to-time it may be necessary to discontinue hardware products, meaning a specific model is declared End of Sale (EoS). When business necessities dictate, newer software releases may remove support for discontinued hardware. When this situation occurs, the most-recent, in-support software release that contains support for the discontinued hardware is referred to as the Last Compatible Software Release. If a release is a Last Compatible Software Release for a specific discontinued hardware model, 24x7 technical support for the release may be extended as required by the End of Software Support (EoS) described in the hardware lifecycle section below.

Example of the Last-Compatible Software Release:

Older versions of EC-XS with 4GB of RAM (PN 200889 and 200900) are supported only up to the ECOS 9.4 release stream, (Release 9.4 is the Last-Compatible Software Release which supports EC-XS PN 200889 and 200900).

Hence customers intending to deploy ECOS 9.5 must refresh their hardware to the latest version of EC-XS or EC-10106.

The 4GB version of EC-XS was declared as End of Sale (EoS) on December 31, 2016.

ECOS 9.4 is planned to be EoM on December 31, 2026. EOST for ECOS 9.4 will be December 31, 2028.

Software Feature with Hardware Dependencies

With each new HPE Aruba Networking EdgeConnect software release, new services and capabilities may be introduced into the release. On occasion, some features may require certain substantial CPU and/or memory requirements to run effectively. In those instances, it may be possible that a new software release introduces a feature that may only run on specific EdgeConnect hardware models. In these cases, customers may still upgrade their SD-WAN gateways to the newer release, but not every new software feature that was introduced in that release may be available for use. In these situations, HPE Aruba Networking will not provide any hardware updates to make those features available – it is up to the customer to decide if they wish to upgrade their hardware at the applicable price to support these new software features. The specific feature compatibility by EdgeConnect model will be documented in the release notes.

Example:

EC-US (PN 201106) and EC-XS (PN 200889 and PN 200900) do not support the IDS/IPS feature across all releases.

Version and Release Stream Numbering

Orchestrator and ECOS software releases utilize 3-digit and 4-digit version numbering schemes, respectively. In addition to these version numbers, Orchestrator and ECOS will also append a build number to identify a specific release build.

The Release Stream for both Orchestrator and ECOS is identified by the first 2 digits. Examples of these are provided below, in this example, the release stream is 9.5.

Orchestrator 9.5.4

- Architecture release number: 9
- Feature release number: 5
- Maintenance release number: 4
- Orchestrator Release stream: 9.5.x

ECOS 9.5.4.1

- Architecture release number: 9
- Feature release number: 5
- Maintenance release number: 4
- Patch release number: 1
- ECOS Release stream: 9.5.x

The definitions for the version schema are as follows:

— Architecture release

Architecture releases may include significant changes in behavior, new major features or functionality, significant increases in performance, new hardware platform support, and/or significant architectural changes. Architecture releases may also include bug fixes.

— Feature release

Feature releases may include newer features, added functionality or minor changes in behavior, and may also address previous product defects.

— Maintenance release

Maintenance releases are generally focused on addressing product defects and security fixes. However, early in a new release stream there may be cases where new features or changes to existing behaviour are introduced in a maintenance release. This may be necessary to bring a new release stream with many features to market in a phased and timely fashion. As a release stream matures, maintenance releases are expected to only contain a limited number of bug fixes and/or security patches.

— Patch release

Patch releases address product defects and security fixes that must be released in an expedient manner.

While the HPE Networking EdgeConnect release numbering scheme generally adheres to the above, customers must thoroughly review the Release Notes that accompany each software release to gain a complete understanding of the impact of any new software release.

EdgeConnect Hardware Lifecycle Overview

As part of the integration into HPE Aruba Networking, the EdgeConnect hardware lifecycle policies have been adapted to better conform with HPE Aruba Networking general End of Life practices. The policy described here is applicable to all existing EdgeConnect customers with active contracts and who have procured their products and continue to transact business through Silver Peak Systems LLC. EdgeConnect gateway products procured from Silver Peak LLC can be optionally enhanced with Silver Peak Systems LLC's Renewable Hardware Maintenance service described below.

For customers who procure their EdgeConnect hardware through HPE Aruba Networking as opposed to Silver Peak Systems LLC, a different set of service offerings and policies is available and described online at [HPE Aruba Networking Support Services | HPE](#).

Hardware Warranty

All EdgeConnect SD-WAN Gateways come with a standard 1-year warranty that starts upon shipment and that provides protection against any hardware defects in material, quality, and workmanship to applicable published specifications. HPE Aruba Networking makes the determination as to the existence and cause of any alleged defect. As part of this warranty, HPE Aruba Networking takes responsibility for and reserves the option to either repair or replace the defective product with the same model or a functional equivalent of HPE Aruba Networking's choosing or to refund the purchase price for the product. The initiation of the replace/repair process must first be authorized by HPE Aruba Networking and can be initiated by contacting customer support and requesting a Return Merchandise Authorization (RMA) for the specific EdgeConnect gateway. This standard warranty requires the return of the defective product before the replacement can be processed.

Hardware warranty entitles a customer to 90 days of 24x7 technical support. However, the purchase of a software subscription entitles a customer to 24x7 technical support for the duration of the subscription. Technical support entitled through a software subscription supersedes that offered by hardware warranty. More information on HPE warranty and support summary is available here: <https://www.hpe.com/psnow/doc/a00143620enw>.

Renewable SD-WAN Gateway Hardware Maintenance

Renewable Hardware Maintenance from Silver Peak Systems LLC is an optional program that provides Advanced Replacement capability for failed EdgeConnect SD-WAN Gateways (henceforth referred to as hardware) and is available from the day the product ships. The offering entails dispatching replacement hardware on the same day, using a Priority or Next Business Day carrier (delivery times vary and are not guaranteed), if the failure is diagnosed and confirmed by HPE Aruba Networking global support by 12:00PM noon, **local time of the supporting depot**. If the failure is diagnosed after the cut-off time, the replacement hardware will be dispatched the next business day instead. This RMA shipment capability is offered in many countries within reach of globally positioned depots. Beyond these countries, the HPE Aruba Networking EdgeConnect team dispatches replacement hardware from the nearest depot, using the fastest standard service. This program entitles the customer to continue receiving Advance Replacement RMA services, with the same-day dispatch policy for each year the maintenance service is active. Although a Priority or "Next Business Day" carrier is utilized when dispatching the RMA, the actual arrival of the RMA to its destination is determined solely by the courier service.

Renewable hardware maintenance starts on the hardware ship date and no gaps in maintenance coverage are allowed. Customers who do not purchase renewable hardware maintenance at the time of hardware shipment may purchase this service at a later point in time (e.g., 1 year later) but must also bridge the gap period between initial ship date and the date when the service is purchased. As part of this service, HPE Aruba Networking pays for all

freight, duties, and taxes associated with RMA and the return of the failed unit. Lapses in hardware maintenance are not permitted—when the hardware maintenance policy for an appliance expires the hardware becomes ineligible for hardware maintenance policy renewal.

Renewable hardware maintenance is not applicable to pluggable transceivers and accessories.

Hardware maintenance is available in multiple terms and is renewable. Eligibility of hardware for renewal hardware maintenance is described by the policy below.

Hardware End of Sale (EoS)

The End of Sale date marks the date after which a hardware product model is no longer orderable. Hardware products deployed in the field will continue to be supported under the terms described earlier. Reasonable attempts will be made to provide End of Sale notification six months before the actual EoS date. In the notification, suitable replacement product(s) are mentioned when applicable. Any EdgeConnect Gateway that is under Hardware Maintenance past the EoS date may be replaced by the same model or a newer, compatible model at the discretion of HPE Aruba Networking.

End of Hardware Maintenance Policy

The original Silver Peak Systems LLC End of Maintenance policy allowed customers to purchase renewable hardware maintenance for up to 5 years from the ship date of the hardware appliance. As of Nov 1, 2023, this policy has been updated to allow the use of renewable hardware maintenance for up to 5 years after the EdgeConnect model is declared EoS. This new policy enables customers with EdgeConnect models currently under a valid hardware maintenance contract to continue purchasing maintenance up until the 5-year milestone post EoS. Notwithstanding the foregoing, the purchase of renewable hardware maintenance as explained above cannot extend beyond EoS plus five years. This policy applies to EdgeConnect models only and includes End of Sale models under the prior End of Maintenance policy (ship date) that have an original End of Maintenance date that falls after Nov 1, 2023.

Example: if an EdgeConnect model was declared End of Sale on Dec 1, 2021, a unit that was shipped on Jan 1, 2019, would have an End of Maintenance date of Jan 1, 2024 (5 years from ship date) per the original Silver Peak Systems LLC policy. Under the new policy, if that unit is still under hardware maintenance as of Nov 1, 2023, then it will continue to be eligible for hardware maintenance until Dec 1, 2026.

The End of Hardware Maintenance is also referred to as the “End of Support Life” (EoSL).

Any EdgeConnect that is under hardware maintenance past the End of Sale date may be replaced by the same model or a newer, compatible model at the discretion of HPE Aruba Networking.

End of Software Support (EoSS)

The EoSS is a date-based milestone that indicates the end of software support for a specific hardware model. The EoSS date is set at 5 years after the declared End of Sale for all hardware sold after Feb 28, 2026. Customers who have purchased hardware up to Feb 28, 2026, will have EoSS date set at 7 years after the declared End of Sale. After the EoSS date, any new software releases may no longer support the hardware model. Documentation of the model will no longer be updated and HPE networking support will no longer provide support for the hardware model.

EoS date mandates that a given Last-Compatible Software Release for an EOS model is in-support until the EoS date.

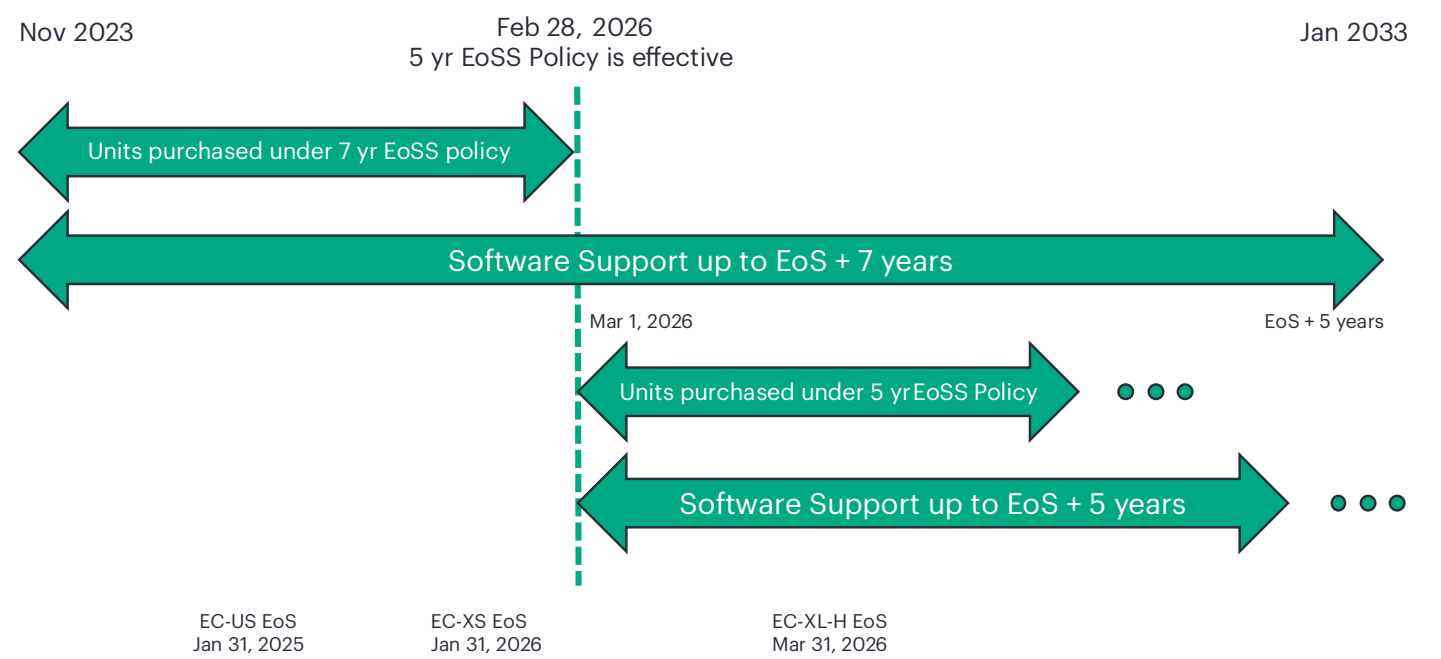


Figure 3: End of Software Support (EoS) Example

Examples

Event	Date
EC-US end of sale announcement	July 2024
EC-US end of sale (EoS)	Jan 31, 2025
Last date to renew HW Maintenance	Jan 31, 2029
EC-US end of HW maintenance (EoSL)	Jan 31, 2030
EC-US end of software support	Jan 31, 2032 (as per old policy)

Event	Date
EC-XL-H end of sale announcement	June 2025
EC-XL-H end of sale (EoS)	Mar 31, 2026
Last date to renew HW Maintenance	Mar 31, 2030
EC-XL-H end of HW maintenance (EoSL)	Mar 31, 2031
EC-XL-H end of software support	Mar 31, 2031 (old policy: Mar 31, 2033)

Summary

Term	Acronym	Reference	Definition	SW / HW Relevance
EdgeConnect Operating System	ECOS		ECOS refers to the software that runs on an EdgeConnect appliance	SW only
Early Access	EA	SW Release state	Initial software release distributed to a limited set of customers	SW only
Generally Available	GA	SW Release state	Meets stability, scalability and performance requirements for broad customer adoption.	SW only
Short Supported Release	SSR	Release designation	Stable release with standard maintenance cycle	SW only
Long Supported Release	LSR	Release designation	Stable release with longer maintenance cycle	SW only
End of Maintenance	EOM	SW Release state	2 years for LSR streams, or when next available SSR stream is GA.	SW only
End of Support	EOST	SW Release state	≥ 2 years after EOM. Announced 12 months prior	SW only
Last Compatible Software Release		Release designation	Last stable release compatible with a given HW model that has been declared EoS	SW, HW
Standard Hardware Warranty		Warranty	1 Year	HW only
End of Sale	EoS	Date	End of Sale date for a specific EdgeConnect HW model Announced 6 months prior	HW only
Last Day to Renew HW Maintenance Contract		Date	4 years after EoS. The service renewal will be limited to a 1-year term.	HW only
End of HW Maintenance (End of Support Life)	EoSL	Date	5 years after End of Sale	HW only
End of Software Support	EoSS	Date	5 years after End of Sale.	SW, HW



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